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Communication of sensor data in a motor vehicle communication network

Abstract

In a vehicular communication network, a processor receives a packet that includes data corresponding to a sensor, the packet being in a first format. The processor reformats the packet in the first format to a second format different than the first format. The reformatting of the packet includes the processor generating an intermediate frame that includes a header in the second format and a payload in the second format, the payload including the data corresponding to the sensor. The processor provides the frame to an Ethernet network interface, which encapsulates the frame in an Ethernet packet. The Ethernet network interface then transmits the Ethernet packet via an Ethernet link.

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCES TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) The present application is a continuation application of U.S. application Ser. No. 17/500,838, filed on Oct. 13, 2021, entitled “Communication of Sensor Data in a Motor Vehicle Communication Network,” which claims the benefit of U.S. Provisional Patent App. No. 63/091,282, entitled “Video Scrambler/Formatter Over Ethernet Network,” filed on Oct. 13, 2020. Both of the applications referenced above are hereby expressly incorporated herein by reference in their entireties.

FIELD OF TECHNOLOGY

(1) The present disclosure relates generally to electronic communications, and more particularly to communications in vehicle communication networks.

BACKGROUND

(2) Motor vehicles (e.g., cars, buses, trucks, etc.) typically include numerous sensors, actuators, displays, computer processors, etc., interconnected by communication links. For instance, a motor vehicle may include one or more cameras, such as one or more rear-facing cameras, one or more side-facing cameras on each side of the vehicle, one or more front-facing cameras, etc. Video data generated by the camera(s) are provided to one or more electronic control units (ECUs) which may implement algorithms/functions associated with driver assistance technologies (e.g., backup assist, park assist, lane centering/keeping assistance, blind spot intervention, automatic braking for collision avoidance, etc.) and/or automated driving systems.

SUMMARY

(3) In an embodiment, a method for communicating in a vehicular communication network includes: receiving, at a processor, data corresponding to a sensor, and generating, at the processor, a frame having a header and a payload. Generating the frame includes: selecting, based on the data corresponding to the sensor, a data type value from a set of multiple data type values corresponding to different respective types of data, the set of multiple data type values including at least i) a first data type value corresponding to video data from a camera, and ii) a second data type value corresponding to non-video data; generating the header to include one or more fields set to the selected data type value to indicate a type of data included in the payload; and generating the payload to include the data received from the sensor. The method also includes: providing, by the processor, the frame to an Ethernet network interface; encapsulating, at the Ethernet network interface, the frame in an Ethernet packet; and transmitting, by the Ethernet network interface, the Ethernet packet via an Ethernet link.

(4) In another embodiment, a communication device comprises: a processor configured to: receive data corresponding to a sensor in a motor vehicle; and generate a frame having a header and a payload. Generating the frame includes: selecting, based on the data corresponding to the sensor, a data type value from a set of multiple data type values corresponding to different respective types of data, the set of multiple data type values including at least i) a first data type value corresponding to video data from a camera, and ii) a second data type value corresponding to non-

video data, generating the header to include one or more fields set to the selected data type value to indicate a type of data included in the payload, and generating the payload to include the data received from the sensor. The communication devices also comprises an Ethernet network interface configured to: receive the frame from the processor, encapsulate the frame in an Ethernet packet, and transmit the Ethernet packet via an Ethernet link.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a simplified block diagram of an example video communication system that utilizes intermediate data frames encapsulated within Ethernet packets, the intermediate data frames having a format suitable for carrying various types of data from various types of sensors in a motor vehicle, according to an embodiment.

(2) FIG. 2 is a simplified block diagram of another example video communication system that utilizes the intermediate data frames having the format suitable for carrying various types of data from various types of sensors in a motor vehicle, according to another embodiment.

(3) FIG. 3 is a simplified block diagram of an example Radar communication system that utilizes the intermediate data frames having the format suitable for carrying various types of data from various types of sensors in a motor vehicle, according to another embodiment.

(4) FIG. 4 is a simplified block diagram of another example Radar communication system that utilizes the intermediate data frames having the format suitable for carrying various types of data from various types of sensors in a motor vehicle, according to another embodiment.

(5) FIG. 5 is a simplified block diagram of an example Lidar communication system that utilizes the intermediate data frames having the format suitable for carrying various types of data from various types of sensors in a motor vehicle, according to another embodiment.

(6) FIG. 6 is a simplified block diagram of another example Lidar communication system that utilizes the intermediate data frames having the format suitable for carrying various types of data from various types of sensors in a motor vehicle, according to another embodiment.

(7) FIG. 7 is a diagram of an example intermediate frame format that is suitable for carrying various types of data from various types of sensors in a motor vehicle, according to an embodiment.

(8) FIG. 8 is a diagram of another example intermediate frame format that is suitable for carrying various types of data from various types of sensors in a motor vehicle, according to another embodiment.

(9) FIG. 9 is a table illustrating an example set of values of a frame type field of the intermediate frame of FIG. 8, according to an embodiment.

(10) FIG. 10 is a table illustrating another example set of values of a frame type field of the intermediate frame of FIG. 8, according to another embodiment.

(11) FIG. 11 is a flow diagram of an example method for communicating in a motor vehicle communication network using intermediate data frames having the format suitable for carrying various types of data from various types of sensors in a motor vehicle, according to an embodiment.

(12) FIG. 12 is a flow diagram of another example method for communicating in a motor vehicle communication network using intermediate data frames having the format suitable for carrying various types of data from various types of sensors in a motor vehicle, according to another embodiment.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(13) In various embodiments described below, data in a motor vehicle communication system is included within data frames (sometimes referred to herein as “intermediate frames”, which in turn

are included within Ethernet packets for transmission via one or more Ethernet links in the motor vehicle communication system. In some embodiments, the intermediate frames have a format suitable for carrying various types of data from various types of sensors, such as video data from cameras, audio data from a microphone, light detection and ranging (Lidar) data from Lidar devices, radio detection and ranging (Radar) data from Radar devices, etc., via Ethernet links. For example, an intermediate frame includes an intermediate frame header and an intermediate frame payload, the intermediate frame header including data type information that indicates a type of data included in the intermediate frame payload, according to some embodiments. As another example, the intermediate frame header additionally or alternatively includes routing information, according to some embodiments. The routing information is used, for example, for populating one or more fields of a header of an Ethernet packet that encapsulates the intermediate frame, the one or more fields of the header of the Ethernet packet being used for routing the Ethernet packet via the motor vehicle communication network, according to some embodiments.

(14) Use of intermediate frames, such as described above, in a motor vehicle communication network that communicates different types of data from different types of sensors helps to unify the processing of the different types of data and/or to use common electronics for processing the different types of data, and thus helps to reduce costs, at least in some embodiments.

(15) FIG. 1 is a simplified block diagram of an example video communication system **100** suitable for use in a motor vehicle, according to an embodiment. The system **100** includes a camera **104** that communicates with a processor **108** via an Ethernet communication link **112**. The video communication system **100** utilizes intermediate frames for communicating data between the camera **104** and the processor **108**. As is described further below, such intermediate frames can be used for communicating data from other types of sensors used in motor vehicles.

(16) The camera **104** generates video data in a suitable video data format. In an embodiment, the camera **104** generates video data in format defined by a suitable Camera Serial Interface (CSI) protocol specification of the Mobile Industry Processor Interface (MIPI) Alliance, such as the CSI-2 protocol, an older version of the CSI protocol, or a future version of the CSI protocol. In another embodiment, the camera **104** generates video data in a format that conforms to a high-definition multimedia interface (HDMI), such as HDMI version 2.1, an older version of HDMI or a future version of HDMI. In other embodiments, the camera **104** generates video data in another suitable format different from format(s) described above, such as according to a Display Serial Interface (DSI) specification of the MIPI Alliance, a DisplayPort (DP) specification of the Video Electronics Standards Association (VESA), a Digital Video Interface (DVI) specification of the Digital Display Working Group (DDWG), a pixel bus, etc.

(17) The processor **108** is configured to process video data in the video data format used by the camera **104**, according to an embodiment. In other embodiments, the processor **108** is configured to process video data in a video data format different from the video data format used by the camera **104**, and the processor **108** includes, or is coupled to, a converter (not shown) that converts the video data output by the camera **104** from the format used by the camera **104** to the format used by the processor **108**.

(18) In an embodiment, the processor **108** comprises a graphics processing unit (GPU). In other embodiments, the processor **108** comprises another suitable processor such as a general purpose processor, a digital signal processor (DSP), etc.

(19) The Ethernet communication link **112** conforms to an automotive Ethernet protocol standard such as the IEEE 802.3ch Standard, the IEEE 802.3cy Standard (now under development), the IEEE 802.3cz Standard (now under development), etc.

(20) A network interface device **120** is communicatively coupled to the camera **104** via a communication link **124**. In an embodiment, the communication link **124** operates according to a suitable physical layer (PHY) protocol specification defined by the MIPI Alliance, such as C-PHY, D-PHY, etc. However, in other embodiments, the communication link **124** operates according to

another suitable physical layer (PHY) protocol different from the PHY protocol specifications defined by the MIPI Alliance, such as PHY protocol compatible with HDMI, DSI, DP, DVI, a pixel bus, etc. For ease of explanation and brevity, the PHY protocol according to which the communication link **124** operates is referred to below as a “non-Ethernet PHY protocol.”

(21) The network interface device **120** includes a non-Ethernet PHY processor **132** (referred to herein as the “PHY processor **132**”) that is configured to perform PHY protocol functions corresponding to the non-Ethernet PHY protocol. For example, the PHY processor **132** is configured to receive data bursts via the communication link **124** and process the data bursts, where such data bursts conform to the non-Ethernet PHY protocol. In an embodiment, the PHY processor **132** processes serial data bursts received via the communication link **124** to generate parallel data.

(22) The PHY processor **132** includes one or more receivers configured to receive signals via the communication link **124**.

(23) The network interface device **120** also includes a sensor interface controller **136** coupled to the PHY processor **132**. The sensor interface controller **136** is configured to receive data from the PHY processor **132** and to format the received data. In an embodiment, the sensor interface controller **136** is configured to perform protocol functions corresponding to a layer above the non-Ethernet PHY protocol corresponding to the communication link **124**.

(24) The sensor interface controller **136** comprises a CSI controller that is configured to perform protocol functions corresponding to a CSI protocol defined by the MIPI Alliance, such as the CSI-2 protocol, which corresponds to a layer above the non-Ethernet PHY protocol in a communication protocol stack, according to an embodiment. In an embodiment in which the sensor interface controller **136** includes a CSI controller, the CSI controller is configured to receive data from the PHY processor **132** and to format the received data into packets having a format conforming to a CSI protocol defined by the MIPI Alliance, such as the CSI-2 protocol.

(25) In other embodiments, the sensor interface controller **136** comprises another suitable interface controller, different from a CSI controller, that is configured to receive data consistent with another suitable PHY protocol (e.g., HDMI, DSI, DP, DVI, a pixel bus, etc.), and to format the received data into packets having another format (different than formats defined by CSI protocols) suitable for exchanging video data.

(26) A formatter **144** is configured to receive data output by the sensor interface controller **136**, and to generate, using the data received from the sensor interface controller **136**, a data frame (sometimes referred to herein as an “intermediate frame”) having a frame header (sometimes referred to herein as an “intermediate frame header”) and a frame payload (sometimes referred to herein as an “intermediate frame payload”).

(27) In the example video communication system **100** of FIG. **1**, the Ethernet communication link **112** communicates video data between the camera **104** and the GPU **108**, and thus frames generated by the formatter **144** include video data in intermediate frame payloads of the intermediate frames. However, according to at least some embodiments, the format of intermediate frames generated by the formatter **144** are suitable for carrying non-video data as well, and thus the formatter **144** is configured for use in other communication systems (distinct from the video communication system **100**) that communicate non-video data, as will be described further below. For example, the formatter **144** is configured for use in communication systems that transfer data from Radar devices, Lidar devices, microphones, temperature sensors, accelerometers, position sensors, velocity sensors, pressure sensors, flow-meters, gas sensors, etc.

(28) To facilitate the use of the formatter **144** for communicating multiple types of data (e.g., video data and non-video data), the intermediate frame header generated by the formatter **144** includes one or more fields that indicate a type of data in the intermediate frame payload, the indicated type of data from among multiple different types of data, according to some embodiments.

(29) To facilitate the use of the formatter **144** for communicating data via Ethernet links, the intermediate frame header generated by the formatter **144** additionally or alternatively includes one

or more fields that include routing information for the intermediate frame (e.g., one or more of a source network identifier (ID), a destination network ID, priority information, virtual local area network (VLAN) information, etc.), according to some embodiments.

(30) In the example video communication system **100** of FIG. **1**, the formatter **144** includes in intermediate frame payloads video data that was received via the communication link **124**. In some embodiments, the formatter **144** also receives non-video data from the camera **104**, such as general purpose input/output (GPIO) data (e.g., indicating values of registers of the camera **104** (e.g., status registers, configuration registers, etc.)), diagnostic data, Operation and Management (OAM) data, data in a user-defined format different than a format used for video data, etc. In some embodiments, the formatter **144** includes such non-video data in intermediate frame payloads.

(31) In some embodiments, the formatter **144** receives such non-video data via a communication link distinct from the communication link **124**, such as a communication link **148**.

(32) An Ethernet media access control layer (MAC) processor **152** is communicatively coupled to the formatter **144**. The Ethernet MAC processor **152** is also coupled to an Ethernet PHY processor **156**. The Ethernet MAC processor **152** and the Ethernet PHY processor **156** may be considered components of an Ethernet network interface that is configured to i) receive intermediate frames from the formatter **144**, ii) encapsulate the intermediate frames in Ethernet packets, and iii) transmit the Ethernet packets via the Ethernet link **112**.

(33) The Ethernet MAC processor **152** is configured perform MAC layer functions corresponding to an automotive Ethernet protocol standard such as the IEEE 802.3ch Standard, the IEEE 802.3cy Standard, the IEEE 802.3cz Standard, etc. For example, the Ethernet MAC processor **152** is configured to receive intermediate frames from the formatter **144** and to generate MAC data units (e.g., Ethernet frames) that encapsulate the intermediate frames.

(34) In some embodiments, the Ethernet MAC processor **152** is configured to generate at least portions of an Ethernet header of an Ethernet frame that encapsulates an intermediate frame using routing information included in an intermediate frame header of the intermediate frame. As an illustrative example, the Ethernet MAC processor **152** is configured to generate a source address (SA) field and a destination address (DA) field of the Ethernet header using a source network ID and a destination network ID, respectively, in the intermediate frame header of the intermediate frame, according to an embodiment.

(35) The Ethernet MAC processor **152** is coupled to an Ethernet PHY processor **156**. The Ethernet PHY processor **156** is configured to receive Ethernet frames from the Ethernet MAC processor **152**, and to convert information in the Ethernet frames to signals for transmission via the Ethernet link **112**. The Ethernet PHY processor **152** includes one or more transmitters configured to transmit signals via the communication link **112**.

(36) A network interface device **160** is communicatively coupled to the network interface device **120** via the Ethernet link **112**. The network interface device **160** is also communicatively coupled to the processor **108** via a communication link **192**. In an embodiment, the communication link **192** operates according to the non-Ethernet PHY protocol by which the communication link **124** operates. For example, the communication link **192** operates according to a suitable PHY protocol specification defined by the MIPI Alliance, such as C-PHY, D-PHY, etc. However, in other embodiments, the communication link **192** operates according to another suitable PHY protocol different from the PHY protocol specifications defined by the MIPI Alliance, such as PHY protocol compatible with HDMI, DSI, DP, DVI, a pixel bus, etc. In some embodiments, the communication link **192** operates according to a non-Ethernet PHY protocol that is different than the non-Ethernet PHY protocol by which the communication link **124** operates.

(37) The network interface device **160** includes an Ethernet PHY processor **168** and an Ethernet MAC processor **172**. The Ethernet MAC processor **172** and the Ethernet PHY processor **168** may be considered components of an Ethernet network interface that is configured to i) receive Ethernet packets via the Ethernet link **112**, ii) decapsulate intermediate frames from the Ethernet packets,

and iii) output the intermediate frames.

(38) The Ethernet PHY processor **168** is configured to receive signals (which were transmitted by the Ethernet PHY processor **156**) via the Ethernet link **112**, and to generate, based on the received signals, Ethernet frames. The Ethernet PHY processor **168** includes one or more receivers configured to receive signals via the communication link **112**.

(39) The Ethernet MAC processor **172** is communicatively coupled to the Ethernet PHY processor **168**. The Ethernet MAC processor **172** is configured to perform MAC layer functions corresponding to the communication protocol according to which the Ethernet MAC processor **152** operates. For example, the Ethernet MAC processor **172** is configured to perform MAC layer functions corresponding to an automotive Ethernet protocol standard such as the IEEE 802.3ch Standard, the IEEE 802.3cy Standard, the IEEE 802.3cz Standard, etc.

(40) The Ethernet MAC processor **172** is configured to receive Ethernet frames from the Ethernet PHY processor **168**, and to decapsulate intermediate frames from the received Ethernet frames.

(41) The Ethernet MAC processor **172** is communicatively coupled to a de-formatter **180**. The de-formatter **180** is configured to receive intermediate frames output by the Ethernet MAC processor **172**, and to use the one or more fields in the intermediate frame headers that indicate types of data included in intermediate frame payloads to convert data in the intermediate frame payloads to other format(s) usable by the network interface **160**. For example, at least for intermediate frames that include video data, the de-formatter **180** is configured to generate, based on the intermediate frames received from the Ethernet MAC processor **172**, data in a format corresponding to a format in which data is output by the sensor interface controller **136**, according to an embodiment. For example, the de-formatter **180** is configured to generate, based on the intermediate frames received from the Ethernet MAC processor **172**, packets having a format conforming to a CSI protocol defined by the MIPI Alliance, such as the CSI-2 protocol. In other embodiments, the de-formatter **180** is configured to generate, based on the intermediate frames received from the Ethernet MAC processor **172**, packets that include data having another format (different than formats defined by CSI protocols) suitable for exchanging video data.

(42) As another example, at least for frames that include non-video data from the camera **104**, the de-formatter **180** is configured to generate, based on the intermediate frames received from the Ethernet MAC processor **172**, data in a format usable by the processor **108**, according to an embodiment.

(43) The network interface device **160** also includes a processor interface controller **184** coupled to the de-formatter **180**. The processor interface controller **184** is configured to perform protocol functions corresponding to the protocol according to which the sensor interface controller **136** operates. In an embodiment, the processor interface controller **184** comprises a CSI controller that is configured to perform protocol functions corresponding to a CSI protocol defined by the MIPI Alliance, such as the CSI-2 protocol. In an embodiment in which the processor interface controller **184** includes a CSI controller, the CSI controller is configured to receive from the de-formatter **180** packets having a format conforming to a CSI protocol defined by the MIPI Alliance, such as the CSI-2 protocol.

(44) In other embodiments, the processor interface controller **184** comprises another suitable interface controller, different from a CSI controller, that is configured to receive packets having another format (different than formats defined by CSI protocols) suitable for exchanging video data.

(45) In some embodiments in which the processor **108** is configured to process video data in a video data format different from the video data format used by the camera **104**, and the processor interface controller **184** converts the video data output by the camera **104** from the format used by the camera **104** to the format used by the processor **108**.

(46) The processor interface controller **184** is also coupled to a non-Ethernet PHY processor **188** (referred to herein as the “PHY processor **188**”) that is configured to perform PHY protocol

functions corresponding to a non-Ethernet PHY protocol associated with a communication link **192**. The PHY processor **188** is communicatively coupled to the processor **108** via the communication link **192**. In an embodiment, the communication link **192** operates according to the non-Ethernet PHY protocol according to which the communication link **124** operates. For example, the communication link **192** operates according to a suitable PHY protocol specification defined by the MIPI Alliance, such as C-PHY, D-PHY, etc. In other embodiments, the communication link **192** operates according to another suitable PHY protocol different from the PHY protocol specifications defined by the MIPI Alliance, such as PHY protocol compatible with HDMI, DSI, DP, DVI, a pixel bus, etc. In other embodiments, the communication link **192** operates according to a suitable non-Ethernet PHY protocol that is different than the non-Ethernet PHY protocol according to which the communication link **124** operates.

(47) The processor interface controller **184** is configured to receive packets from the de-formatter **180** and to provide the data from the received packets to the PHY processor **188** in a suitable format. The PHY processor **188** is configured to transmit data received from the processor interface controller **184** in data bursts via the communication link **192**. In an embodiment, the PHY processor **188** receives data in parallel from the processor interface controller **184**, and transmits serial data bursts via the communication link **192**.

(48) The PHY processor **188** includes one or more transmitters configured to transmit signals via the communication link **192**.

(49) In the example video communication system **100** of FIG. **1**, the de-formatter **180** also receives intermediate frames that include non-video data from the camera **104**, such as GPIO data (e.g., indicating values of registers of the camera **104** (e.g., status registers, configuration registers, etc.)), diagnostic data, OAM data, data in a user-defined format different than a format used for video data, etc. In some embodiments, the de-formatter **180** provides such non-video data to the processor **108** via a communication link distinct from the communication link **192**, such as a communication link **196**.

(50) The formatter **144** is a processor that is configured to receive data corresponding to an output of a sensor (e.g., the camera **104**, a microphone, a Lidar device, a Radar device, etc.), and to generate, using the data corresponding to output of the sensor, the intermediate frame having the intermediate frame header and the intermediate frame payload. In some embodiments, the processor is configured to perform one or more other operations of the formatter **144** described above.

(51) According to an embodiment, the processor (formatter **144**) comprises circuitry configured to receive data corresponding to an output of a sensor (e.g., the camera **104**, a microphone, a Lidar device, a Radar device, etc.), and to generate, using the data corresponding to output of the sensor, the intermediate frame having the intermediate frame header and the intermediate frame payload. In various embodiments, the circuitry is configured to perform one or more other operations of the formatter **144** described above.

(52) According to another embodiment, the processor (formatter **144**) is configured to execute machine readable instructions stored in a memory; and the memory stores machine readable instructions that, when executed by the processor, cause the processor to receive data corresponding to an output of a sensor (e.g., the camera **104**, a microphone, a Lidar device, a Radar device, etc.), and to generate, using the data corresponding to output of the sensor, the intermediate frame having the intermediate frame header and the intermediate frame payload. In various embodiments, the memory also stores machine readable instructions that, when executed by the processor, cause the processor to perform one or more other operations of the formatter **144** described above.

(53) The de-formatter **180** is a processor that is configured to receive intermediate frames from an Ethernet network interface, and to use the one or more fields in the intermediate frame headers that indicate types of data included in intermediate frame payloads to convert data in the intermediate

frame payloads to other format(s) usable by a network interface that is communicatively coupled to a processor (e.g., the processor **108**). In various embodiments, the processor is also configured to perform one or more other operations of the de-formatter **180** described above.

(54) According to an embodiment, the processor (de-formatter **180**) comprises circuitry configured to use the one or more fields in the intermediate frame headers that indicate types of data included in intermediate frame payloads to convert data in the intermediate frame payloads to other format(s) usable by a network interface that is communicatively coupled to a processor (e.g., the processor **108**). In various embodiments, the circuitry is also configured to perform one or more other operations of the de-formatter **180** described above.

(55) According to another embodiment, the processor (de-formatter **180**) is configured to execute machine readable instructions stored in a memory; and the memory stores machine readable instructions that, when executed by the processor, cause the processor to receive intermediate frames from an Ethernet network interface, and to use the one or more fields in the intermediate frame headers that indicate types of data included in intermediate frame payloads to convert data in the intermediate frame payloads to other format(s) usable by a network interface that is communicatively coupled to a processor (e.g., the processor **108**). In various embodiments, the memory also stores machine readable instructions that, when executed by the processor, cause the processor to perform one or more other operations of the de-formatter **180** described above.

(56) FIG. **2** is a simplified block diagram of another example video communication system **200** suitable for use in a motor vehicle, according to another embodiment. The video communication system **200** is similar to the video communication system **100** of FIG. **1**, and like-numbered elements are not described again in detail for purposes of brevity.

(57) In the system **200**, the processor **108** and the network interface **160** of the system **100** of FIG. **1** are replaced with a processor **204** with an integrated network interface **208**. In an embodiment, the processor **204** comprises a GPU. In other embodiments, the processor **204** comprises another suitable processor such as a general purpose processor, a DSP, etc.

(58) The network interface **208** includes a de-formatter **212**. The de-formatter **212** is configured to receive intermediate frames output by the Ethernet MAC processor **172**, and to use the one or more fields in the intermediate frame headers that indicate types of data included in intermediate frame payloads to convert data in the intermediate frame payloads to other format(s) usable by the processor **204**. For example, at least for intermediate frames that include video data, the de-formatter **212** is configured to generate, based on the intermediate frames received from the Ethernet MAC processor **172**, data in a format corresponding to a format in which data is output by the sensor interface controller **136**, according to an embodiment. For example, the de-formatter **212** is configured to generate, based on the intermediate frames received from the Ethernet MAC processor **172**, packets having a format conforming to a CSI protocol defined by the MIPI Alliance, such as the CSI-2 protocol. In other embodiments, the de-formatter **212** is configured to generate, based on the intermediate frames received from the Ethernet MAC processor **172**, packets that include data having another format (different than formats defined by CSI protocols) suitable for exchanging video data.

(59) As another example, at least for frames that include non-video data from the camera **104**, the de-formatter **212** is configured to generate, based on the intermediate frames received from the Ethernet MAC processor **172**, data in a format usable by the processor **204**, according to an embodiment.

(60) Referring to FIGS. **1** and **2**, the formatter **144** generates, as discussed above, intermediate frame headers that include one or more fields having routing information, and the routing information according to some embodiments, and the Ethernet MAC processor **152** generates at least portions of an Ethernet header of an Ethernet frame using the routing information. In some embodiments, the network interface **120** and the network interface **160** of the system **100** are communicatively coupled via a Layer-2 switch (e.g., an Ethernet switch, not shown), and the

Layer-2 switch uses routing information in the Ethernet header to route the Ethernet frame from the network interface **120** to the network interface **160**. Similarly, in some embodiments, the network interface **120** and the processor **204** of the system **200** are communicatively coupled via a Layer-2 switch (e.g., an Ethernet switch, not shown), and the Layer-2 switch uses routing information in the Ethernet header to route the Ethernet frame from the network interface **120** to the processor **204**.

(61) The de-formatter **212** is a processor that is configured to receive intermediate frames from an Ethernet network interface, and to use the one or more fields in the intermediate frame headers that indicate types of data included in intermediate frame payloads to convert data in the intermediate frame payloads to other format(s) usable by a processor (e.g., the processor **204**). In various other embodiments, the processor is also configured to perform one or more other operations of the de-formatter **212** described above.

(62) According to an embodiment, the processor (de-formatter **212**) comprises circuitry configured to receive intermediate frames from an Ethernet network interface, and to use the one or more fields in the intermediate frame headers that indicate types of data included in intermediate frame payloads to convert data in the intermediate frame payloads to other format(s) usable by a processor (e.g., the processor **204**). In various other embodiments, the circuitry is also configured to perform one or more other operations of the de-formatter **212** described above.

(63) According to another embodiment, the processor (de-formatter **212**) is configured to execute machine readable instructions stored in a memory; and the memory stores machine readable instructions that, when executed by the processor, cause the processor to receive intermediate frames from an Ethernet network interface, and to use the one or more fields in the intermediate frame headers that indicate types of data included in intermediate frame payloads to convert data in the intermediate frame payloads to other format(s) usable by a processor (e.g., the processor **204**). In various embodiments, the memory also stores machine readable instructions that, when executed by the processor, cause the processor to perform one or more other operations of the de-formatter **212** described above.

(64) FIG. **3** is a simplified block diagram of an example Radar communication system **300** suitable for use in a motor vehicle, according to an embodiment. The Radar communication system **300** is structured similarly to the video communication system **100** of FIG. **1**, and like-numbered elements are not described again in detail for purposes of brevity.

(65) The system **300** includes a Radar device **304** (“Radar **304**”) that communicates with the processor **108** via the Ethernet communication link **112**. The Radar **304** generates Radar data in a suitable data format.

(66) A network interface device **320** is communicatively coupled to the Radar **304** via a communication link **324**. The communication link **324** operates according to a non-Ethernet PHY protocol suitable for communicating Radar data.

(67) The network interface device **320** includes a non-Ethernet PHY processor **332** (referred to herein as the “PHY processor **332**”) that is configured to perform PHY protocol functions corresponding to the non-Ethernet PHY protocol. For example, the PHY processor **332** is configured to receive data bursts via the communication link **324** and process the data bursts, where such data bursts conform to the non-Ethernet PHY protocol. In an embodiment, the PHY processor **332** processes serial data bursts received via the communication link **324** to generate parallel data.

(68) The PHY processor **332** includes one or more receivers configured to receive signals via the communication link **324**.

(69) The network interface device **320** also includes a sensor interface controller **336** coupled to the PHY processor **332**. The sensor interface controller **336** is configured to receive data from the PHY processor **332** and to format the received data in format suitable for communicating Radar data. In an embodiment, the sensor interface controller **336** is configured to perform protocol functions corresponding to a layer above the non-Ethernet PHY protocol corresponding to the communication link **324**.

(70) The formatter **144** is configured to receive data output by the sensor interface controller **336**, and to generate, using the data received from the sensor interface controller **336**, an intermediate frame such as described above. For example, one or more fields of the intermediate frame header that indicate a type of data in an intermediate frame payload are set to indicate that the intermediate frame payload includes Radar data.

(71) The formatter **144** additionally or alternatively generates one or more fields of the intermediate frame header to include routing information for the intermediate frame (e.g., one or more of a source network ID, a destination network ID, priority information, VLAN information, etc.), according to some embodiments.

(72) In the example Radar communication system **300** of FIG. **3**, the formatter **144** includes in intermediate frame payloads Radar data that was received via the communication link **324**. In some embodiments, the formatter **144** also receives non-Radar data from the Radar **304**, such as GPIO data (e.g., indicating values of registers of the Radar **304** (e.g., status registers, configuration registers, etc.)), diagnostic data, OAM data, data in a user-defined format different than a format used for Radar data, etc. In some embodiments, the formatter **144** includes in intermediate frame payloads such non-Radar data.

(73) In some embodiments, the formatter **144** receives such non-Radar data via a communication link distinct from the communication link **324**, such as a communication link **348**.

(74) A network interface **360** is communicatively coupled to the processor **108**. The network interface **360** includes the de-formatter **180**, which is configured to receive intermediate frames output by the Ethernet MAC processor **172**, and to use the one or more fields in the intermediate frame headers that indicate types of data included in intermediate frame payloads to convert data in the intermediate frame payloads to other format(s) usable by the network interface **360**. For example, at least for intermediate frames that include Radar data, the de-formatter **180** is configured to generate, based on the intermediate frames received from the Ethernet MAC processor **172**, data in a format corresponding to a format in which data is output by the sensor interface controller **336**, according to an embodiment.

(75) As another example, at least for frames that include non-Radar data from the Radar **304**, the de-formatter **180** is configured to generate, based on the intermediate frames received from the Ethernet MAC processor **172**, data in a format usable by the processor **108**, according to an embodiment.

(76) A processor interface controller **384** is coupled to the de-formatter **180**. The processor interface controller **384** is configured to perform protocol functions corresponding to the protocol according to which the sensor interface controller **336** operates.

(77) The processor interface controller **384** is also coupled to a non-Ethernet PHY processor **388** (referred to herein as the “PHY processor **388**”) that is configured to perform PHY protocol functions corresponding to the non-Ethernet PHY protocol. The PHY processor **388** is communicatively coupled to the processor **108** via a communication link **392**. In an embodiment, the communication link **392** operates according to the non-Ethernet PHY protocol according to which the communication link **324** operates.

(78) The processor interface controller **384** is configured to receive packets from the de-formatter **180** and to provide the data from the received packets to the PHY processor **388** in a suitable format. The PHY processor **388** is configured to transmit data received from the processor interface controller **384** in data bursts via the communication link **392**. In an embodiment, the PHY processor **388** receives data in parallel from the processor interface controller **384**, and transmits serial data bursts via the communication link **392**.

(79) The PHY processor **388** includes one or more transmitters configured to transmit signals via the communication link **392**.

(80) In the example Radar communication system **300** of FIG. **3**, the de-formatter **180** also receives intermediate frames that include non-Radar data from the Radar **304**, such as GPIO data (e.g.,

indicating values of registers of the Radar **304** (e.g., status registers, configuration registers, etc.)), diagnostic data, OAM data, data in a user-defined format different than a format used for Radar data, etc. In some embodiments, the de-formatter **180** provides such non-Radar data to the processor **108** via a communication link distinct from the communication link **392**, such as a communication link **396**.

(81) FIG. **4** is a simplified block diagram of another example Radar communication system **400** suitable for use in a motor vehicle, according to another embodiment. The Radar communication system **400** is similar to the Radar communication system **300** of FIG. **3**, and like-numbered elements are not described again in detail for purposes of brevity.

(82) The de-formatter **212** is configured to receive intermediate frames output by the Ethernet MAC processor **172**, and to use the one or more fields in the intermediate frame headers that indicate types of data included in intermediate frame payloads to convert data in the intermediate frame payloads to other format(s) usable by the processor **204**. For example, at least for intermediate frames that include Radar data, the de-formatter **212** is configured to generate, based on the intermediate frames received from the Ethernet MAC processor **172**, data in a format corresponding to a format in which data is output by the sensor interface controller **336**, according to an embodiment.

(83) As another example, at least for frames that include non-Radar data from the Radar **304**, the de-formatter **212** is configured to generate, based on the intermediate frames received from the Ethernet MAC processor **172**, data in a format usable by the processor **204**, according to an embodiment.

(84) Referring to FIGS. **3** and **4**, the formatter **144** generates, as discussed above, intermediate frame headers that include one or more fields having routing information, and the routing information according to some embodiments, and the Ethernet MAC processor **152** generates at least portions of an Ethernet header of an Ethernet frame using the routing information. In some embodiments, the network interface **320** and the network interface **360** of the system **300** are communicatively coupled via a Layer-2 switch (e.g., an Ethernet switch, not shown), and the Layer-2 switch uses routing information in the Ethernet header to route the Ethernet frame from the network interface **320** to the network interface **360**. Similarly, in some embodiments, the network interface **320** and the processor **204** of the system **400** are communicatively coupled via a Layer-2 switch (e.g., an Ethernet switch, not shown), and the Layer-2 switch uses routing information in the Ethernet header to route the Ethernet frame from the network interface **320** to the processor **204**.

(85) FIG. **5** is a simplified block diagram of an example Lidar communication system **500** suitable for use in a motor vehicle, according to an embodiment. The Lidar communication system **500** is structured similarly to the video communication system **100** of FIG. **1** and the Radar communication system **300** of FIG. **3**, and like-numbered elements are not described again in detail for purposes of brevity.

(86) The system **500** includes a Lidar device **504** (“Lidar **504**”) that communicates with the processor **108** via the Ethernet communication link **112**. The Lidar **504** generates Lidar data in a suitable data format.

(87) A network interface device **520** is communicatively coupled to the Lidar **504** via a communication link **524**. The communication link **524** operates according to a non-Ethernet PHY protocol suitable for communicating Lidar data.

(88) The network interface device **520** includes a non-Ethernet PHY processor **532** (referred to herein as the “PHY processor **532**”) that is configured to perform PHY protocol functions corresponding to the non-Ethernet PHY protocol. For example, the PHY processor **532** is configured to receive data bursts via the communication link **524** and process the data bursts, where such data bursts conform to the non-Ethernet PHY protocol. In an embodiment, the PHY processor **532** processes serial data bursts received via the communication link **524** to generate parallel data.

(89) The PHY processor **532** includes one or more receivers configured to receive signals via the

communication link **524**.

(90) The network interface device **520** also includes a sensor interface controller **536** coupled to the PHY processor **532**. The sensor interface controller **536** is configured to receive data from the PHY processor **532** and to format the received data in format suitable for communicating Lidar data. In an embodiment, the sensor interface controller **536** is configured to perform protocol functions corresponding to a layer above the non-Ethernet PHY protocol corresponding to the communication link **524**.

(91) The formatter **144** is configured to receive data output by the sensor interface controller **536**, and to generate, using the data received from the sensor interface controller **536**, an intermediate frame such as described above. For example, one or more fields of the intermediate frame header that indicate a type of data in an intermediate frame payload are set to indicate that the intermediate frame payload includes Lidar data.

(92) The formatter **144** additionally or alternatively generates one or more fields of the intermediate frame header to include routing information for the intermediate frame (e.g., one or more of a source network ID, a destination network ID, priority information, VLAN information, etc.), according to some embodiments.

(93) In the example Lidar communication system **500** of FIG. 5, the formatter **144** includes in intermediate frame payloads Lidar data that was received via the communication link **524**. In some embodiments, the formatter **144** also receives non-Lidar data from the Lidar **504**, such as GPIO data (e.g., indicating values of registers of the Lidar **504** (e.g., status registers, configuration registers, etc.)), diagnostic data, OAM data, data in a user-defined format different than a format used for Lidar data, etc. In some embodiments, the formatter **144** includes in intermediate frame payloads such non-Lidar data.

(94) In some embodiments, the formatter **144** receives such non-Lidar data via a communication link distinct from the communication link **524**, such as a communication link **548**.

(95) A network interface **560** is communicatively coupled to the processor **108**. The network interface **560** includes the de-formatter **180**, which is configured to receive intermediate frames output by the Ethernet MAC processor **172**, and to use the one or more fields in the intermediate frame headers that indicate types of data included in intermediate frame payloads to convert data in the intermediate frame payloads to other format(s) usable by the network interface **560**. For example, at least for intermediate frames that include Lidar data, the de-formatter **180** is configured to generate, based on the intermediate frames received from the Ethernet MAC processor **172**, data in a format corresponding to a format in which data is output by the sensor interface controller **536**, according to an embodiment.

(96) As another example, at least for frames that include non-Lidar data from the Lidar **504**, the de-formatter **180** is configured to generate, based on the intermediate frames received from the Ethernet MAC processor **172**, data in a format usable by the processor **108**, according to an embodiment.

(97) A processor interface controller **584** is coupled to the de-formatter **180**. The processor interface controller **584** is configured to perform protocol functions corresponding to the protocol according to which the sensor interface controller **536** operates.

(98) The processor interface controller **584** is also coupled to a non-Ethernet PHY processor **588** (referred to herein as the “PHY processor **588**”) that is configured to perform PHY protocol functions corresponding to the non-Ethernet PHY protocol. The PHY processor **588** is communicatively coupled to the processor **108** via a communication link **592**. In an embodiment, the communication link **592** operates according to the non-Ethernet PHY protocol according to which the communication link **524** operates.

(99) The processor interface controller **584** is configured to receive packets from the de-formatter **180** and to provide the data from the received packets to the PHY processor **588** in a suitable format. The PHY processor **588** is configured to transmit data received from the processor interface

controller **584** in data bursts via the communication link **592**. In an embodiment, the PHY processor **588** receives data in parallel from the processor interface controller **584**, and transmits serial data bursts via the communication link **592**.

(100) The PHY processor **588** includes one or more transmitters configured to transmit signals via the communication link **592**.

(101) In the example Lidar communication system **500** of FIG. 5, the de-formatter **180** also receives intermediate frames that include non-Lidar data from the Lidar **504**, such as GPIO data (e.g., indicating values of registers of the Lidar **504** (e.g., status registers, configuration registers, etc.)), diagnostic data, OAM data, data in a user-defined format different than a format used for Lidar data, etc. In some embodiments, the de-formatter **180** provides such non-Lidar data to the processor **108** via a communication link distinct from the communication link **592**, such as a communication link **596**.

(102) FIG. 6 is a simplified block diagram of another example Lidar communication system **600** suitable for use in a motor vehicle, according to another embodiment. The Lidar communication system **600** is similar to the Lidar communication system **500** of FIG. 5, and like-numbered elements are not described again in detail for purposes of brevity.

(103) The de-formatter **212** is configured to receive intermediate frames output by the Ethernet MAC processor **172**, and to use the one or more fields in the intermediate frame headers that indicate types of data included in intermediate frame payloads to convert data in the intermediate frame payloads to other format(s) usable by the processor **204**. For example, at least for intermediate frames that include Lidar data, the de-formatter **212** is configured to generate, based on the intermediate frames received from the Ethernet MAC processor **172**, data in a format corresponding to a format in which data is output by the sensor interface controller **336**, according to an embodiment.

(104) As another example, at least for frames that include non-Lidar data from the Lidar **504**, the de-formatter **212** is configured to generate, based on the intermediate frames received from the Ethernet MAC processor **172**, data in a format usable by the processor **204**, according to an embodiment.

(105) Referring to FIGS. 5 and 6, the formatter **144** generates, as discussed above, intermediate frame headers that include one or more fields having routing information, and the routing information according to some embodiments, and the Ethernet MAC processor **152** generates at least portions of an Ethernet header of an Ethernet frame using the routing information. In some embodiments, the network interface **520** and the network interface **560** of the system **500** are communicatively coupled via a Layer-2 switch (e.g., an Ethernet switch, not shown), and the Layer-2 switch uses routing information in the Ethernet header to route the Ethernet frame from the network interface **520** to the network interface **560**. Similarly, in some embodiments, the network interface **520** and the processor **204** of the system **600** are communicatively coupled via a Layer-2 switch (e.g., an Ethernet switch, not shown), and the Layer-2 switch uses routing information in the Ethernet header to route the Ethernet frame from the network interface **520** to the processor **204**.

(106) FIG. 7 is a diagram of an example intermediate frame **700** that a formatter, such as the formatter **144** of FIGS. 1-6, is configured to generate and the de-formatter **180/212** (FIGS. 1-6) is configured to process, according to an embodiment. The intermediate frame **700** has a format suitable for carrying various types of data from various types of sensors, such as video data from cameras, audio data from a microphone, Lidar data from Lidar devices, Radar data from Radar devices, etc., via Ethernet links.

(107) The intermediate frame **700** includes an intermediate frame header **704** and an intermediate frame payload **708**. The intermediate frame header **704** includes frame type information **724** that indicates a type of data included in the payload **708**. The intermediate frame header **704** also includes routing information **728** that is useful for routing the intermediate frame (within an Ethernet frame) via an Ethernet network.

(108) The frame type information **724** facilitates the use of the intermediate frame **700** for communicating multiple types of data (e.g., video data and non-video data). The frame type information **724** corresponds to one or more fields that indicate a type of data in the payload **708**, the indicated type of data from among multiple different types of data, according to some embodiments.

(109) The routing information **728** facilitates the use of the frame **700** for communicating data via Ethernet links and/or Ethernet switches, according to some embodiments. The routing information **728** corresponds to one or more fields that include routing information for the intermediate frame **700** (e.g., one or more of a source network ID, a destination network ID, priority information, VLAN information, etc.), according to some embodiments. In some embodiments, the routing information **728** is used, for example, for populating one or more fields of a header of an Ethernet packet that encapsulates the intermediate frame **700**, the one or more fields of the header of the Ethernet packet being used for routing the Ethernet packet via a motor vehicle communication network, according to some embodiments.

(110) In an embodiment, the intermediate frame **700** is generated by a formatter such as the formatter **144** discussed above with reference to FIGS. **1-6**. For example, the formatter **144** receives data from a sensor, encapsulates the data in the payload **708**, and sets the frame type information **724** to indicate a type of the data in the payload **708**. Upon receiving the intermediate frame **700**, a de-formatter, such as the de-formatter **180/212** discussed above with reference to FIGS. **1-6**, uses the frame type information **724** to re-format the data in the payload **708** into an appropriate format for communication to and/or use by a processor, such as the processor **108/204** (FIGS. **1-6**), according to some embodiments.

(111) In some embodiments, an Ethernet network interface is configured to generate (e.g., the Ethernet MAC processor **152** is configured to generate) at least portions of an Ethernet header of an Ethernet frame that encapsulates an intermediate frame **700** using the routing information **728**. As an illustrative example, the Ethernet network interface generates (e.g., the Ethernet MAC processor **152** generates) an SA field and a DA field of the Ethernet header using the routing information **728**, according to an embodiment. As another illustrative example, the Ethernet network interface generates (e.g., the Ethernet MAC processor **152** generates) an IEEE 802.1Q tag field of the Ethernet header using the routing information **728**, according to an embodiment. In some embodiments, one or more Ethernet switches in a motor vehicle communication network use information in the Ethernet header (e.g., one of, or any suitable combination of two or more of, the SA field, the DA field, the 802.1Q tag field, etc.) to route the Ethernet frame to an intended end point, e.g., a processor such as the processor **108/204**.

(112) FIG. **8** is a diagram of another example intermediate frame **800** that a formatter, such as the formatter **144** of FIGS. **1-6**, is configured to generate and the de-formatter **180/212** (FIGS. **1-6**) is configured to process, according to an embodiment. The intermediate frame **800** is an example implementation of the intermediate frame **700** of FIG. **7**, according to an embodiment. The intermediate frame **800** has a format suitable for carrying various types of data from various types of sensors, such as video data from cameras, audio data from a microphone, Lidar data from Lidar devices, Radar data from Radar devices, etc., via Ethernet links.

(113) The intermediate frame **800** includes an intermediate frame header **804** and an intermediate frame payload **808**. The intermediate frame header **804** includes frame type information **824** that indicates a type of data included in the payload **808**. The intermediate frame header **804** also includes routing information **828** that is useful for routing the intermediate frame (within an Ethernet frame) via an Ethernet network.

(114) The routing information **828** corresponds to a stream source ID field **840**, a stream destination ID field **844**, and a classification field **848**. In an embodiment, the classification field **848** includes priority information. In another embodiment, the classification field **848** additionally or alternatively includes VLAN information. For example, in one embodiment, the classification

field **848** includes a first subfield that includes priority information and a second subfield that includes VLAN information.

(115) In an embodiment, in connection with receiving the intermediate frame **800**, an Ethernet network interface generates (e.g., the Ethernet MAC processor **152** generates) an SA field and a DA field of the Ethernet header using information in the stream source ID field **840**, a stream destination ID field **844**, respectively. In another embodiment, the Ethernet network interface additionally or alternatively generates (e.g., the Ethernet MAC processor **152** generates) an 802.1Q tag field of the Ethernet header using information in the classification field **848**. For example, the Ethernet network interface generates (e.g., the Ethernet MAC processor **152** generates) a priority code point (PCP) subfield and a VLAN identifier (VID) subfield of the 802.1Q tag field of the Ethernet header using the first subfield that includes priority information and the second subfield that includes VLAN information, respectively, of the classification field **848**.

(116) In an embodiment, the frame type information **824** corresponds to a frame type field **860**, where different values of the frame type field **860** indicate respective different types of data included in the payload **808**. In another embodiment, the frame type information **824** also corresponds to a frame subtype field (not shown). In such embodiments, different values of the frame type field **860** indicate respective different types of data included in the payload **808**, and different values of the frame subtype field indicate respective different subtypes of data (within the type of data indicated by the frame type field **860**) included in the payload **808**.

(117) FIG. **9** is a table illustrating an example set of values **900** of the frame type field **860** (FIG. **8**), according to an embodiment. Each row of the table **900** corresponds to a respective different type of data included in the payload **808**, and each row of the table **900** corresponds to a respective different value of the frame type field **860**, according to an embodiment.

(118) The set of values **900** includes a first subset of values **904** that correspond to video-type data, and a second subset of values **908** that correspond to non-video-type data. In some embodiments, the first subset of values **904** includes one or more values **912** that are each relevant for video data in any of multiple different formats. In some embodiments, the first subset of values additionally or alternatively includes one or more values **916** corresponding to respective different types of video data to standards other than CSI, such as HDCP, EDID, etc.

(119) The values **912** includes a value indicating that the payload **808** includes data corresponding to a frame start; a value indicating that the payload **808** includes data corresponding to a frame end; a value indicating that the payload **808** includes data corresponding to a line start; a value indicating that the payload **808** includes data corresponding to a line end; a value indicating that the payload **808** includes data corresponding to a blanking interval; and a value indicating that the payload **808** includes data corresponding to pixel values (e.g., YUV data, RGB data, raw data, etc.).

(120) The values **916** includes a value indicating that the payload **808** includes HDCP data; a value indicating that the payload **808** includes EDID data; etc.

(121) The subset of values **908** includes a value indicating that the payload **808** includes HDMI CEC data; a value indicating that the payload **808** includes audio data; a value indicating that the payload **808** includes Lidar data; a value indicating that the payload **808** includes Radar data; a value indicating that the payload **808** includes OAM data; a value indicating that the payload **808** includes diagnostics data; a value indicating that the payload **808** includes GPIO and/or remote register access data; and a value indicating that the payload **808** includes data in a user-defined format.

(122) In various other embodiments, one or more of the values in the set of values **900** is omitted, and/or one or more other values corresponding to other types of data are included among the set of values **900**.

(123) Referring to FIGS. **7** and **9**, in some embodiments in which the header **704** includes a frame type field, each row of the table **900** corresponds to a respective different value of the frame type field, according to an embodiment.

(124) FIG. 10 is a table illustrating another example set of values **1000** of the frame type field **860** (FIG. 8), according to another embodiment. The set of values **1000** is used when the header **804** also includes a sub-type field as part of the frame type information **824**. Each row of the table **1000** corresponds to a respective different type of data included in the payload **808**, and each row of the table **1000** corresponds to a respective different value of the frame type field **860**, according to an embodiment.

(125) The set of values **1000** includes a first value **1004** that corresponds to video-type data; and a subset of values **1008** that correspond to non-video-type data.

(126) When the frame type field **860** is set to a particular value illustrated in FIG. 10, the sub-type field of the header **804** is set to a value to indicate a particular sub-type of data included in the payload **808**, at least for some values of the frame type field **860**. For example, when the frame type field **860** is set to the first value **1004**, different values of the sub-type field indicate different respective sub-types of video data. In an embodiment, when the frame type field **860** is set to the first value **1004**, different values of the sub-type field correspond to different types of video data in the third subset of values **912** and/or the fourth subset of values **916** of FIG. 9.

(127) When the frame type field **860** is set to a value corresponding to GPIO/Diagnostics/Remote register access, different values of the sub-type field indicate whether the data in the payload corresponds to GPIO data, diagnostics data, or remote register access data, according to an embodiment.

(128) In various other embodiments, one or more of the values in the set of values **1000** is omitted, and/or one or more other values corresponding to other types of data are included among the set of values **1000**. As an illustrative example, the subset of values **1008** includes one or more other types of non-video data and/or one or more of the values illustrated in FIG. 10 are omitted, according to various embodiments. In some embodiments, one or more of the types of data indicated in FIG. 10 in the set of values **1000** are grouped into a single value of the frame type field **860**, and the sub-type field is set to distinguish between different sub-types of data.

(129) Referring to FIGS. 7 and 10, in some embodiments in which the header **704** includes a frame type field and a frame sub-type field, each row of the table **1000** corresponds to a respective different value of the frame type field, according to an embodiment.

(130) FIG. 11 is a flow diagram of an example method **1100** for communicating in a motor vehicle communication network, according to an embodiment. The method **1100** is implemented by a network interface such as the network interface **120/320/520** of FIGS. 1-6, according to various embodiments. The method **1100** is implemented in another suitable network interface in other embodiments.

(131) At block **1104**, a processor (e.g., the formatter **144**) receives data corresponding to a sensor. In an embodiment, the sensor is included in a motor vehicle. In at least some instances, the data received at block **1104** is sensing data output by the sensor (e.g., video data output by a camera; audio data output by a microphone; Lidar data output by a Lidar device; Radar data output by a Radar device; etc.). In other instances, the data received at block **1104** comprises diagnostics data, OAM data, GPIO data, values of registers of the sensor (e.g., status registers, configuration registers, etc.), data in a user-defined format different than a format used for the sensing data, etc. In an embodiment, receiving data at block **1104** includes receiving data from a sensor interface controller such as the sensor interface controller **136/336/536** of FIGS. 1-6. In some instances, receiving data at block **1104** includes receiving data from a communication link such as the communication link **148/348/548** of FIGS. 1-6.

(132) At block **1108**, the processor generates an intermediate frame having an intermediate frame header and an intermediate frame payload. Generating the intermediate frame at block **1108** includes the processor selecting, at block **1112**, a data type value for the data received at block **1104** from a set of multiple data type values corresponding to different respective types of data. In an embodiment, the set of multiple data types includes at least i) a first data type corresponding to

video data from a camera, and ii) a second data type value corresponding non-video data.

(133) In some embodiments and/or implementations, the data received at block **1104** includes data type information that indicates a data type of the data received at block **1104**, and the processor uses the data type information in the data received at block **1104** to select the data type value at block **1112**. For example, CSI packets include a Data ID field that includes data type information that indicates a data type included in the CSI packet. In some embodiments and/or implementations in which receiving data at block **1104** includes receiving a CSI packet, the processor uses the data type information in the Data ID field of the CSI packet to select the data type value at block **1112**.

(134) As an illustrative example, if the Data ID field of the CSI packet indicates the data includes a frame start, the processor selects the data type value at block **1112** to indicate video-type data and optionally to indicate a frame start. As another illustrative example, if the Data ID field of the CSI packet indicates the data includes a frame end, the processor selects the data type value at block **1112** to indicate video-type data and optionally to indicate a frame end. As another illustrative example, if the Data ID field of the CSI packet indicates the data includes a line start, the processor selects the data type value at block **1112** to indicate video-type data and optionally to indicate a line start. As another illustrative example, if the Data ID field of the CSI packet indicates the data includes a line end, the processor selects the data type value at block **1112** to indicate video-type data and optionally to indicate a line end. As another illustrative example, if the Data ID field of the CSI packet indicates the data includes blanking interval information, the processor selects the data type value at block **1112** to indicate video-type data and optionally to indicate blanking interval data. As another illustrative example, if the Data ID field of the CSI packet indicates the data includes YUV data, the processor selects the data type value at block **1112** to indicate video-type data and optionally to indicate YUV data. As another illustrative example, if the Data ID field of the CSI packet indicates the data includes RGB data, the processor selects the data type value at block **1112** to indicate video-type data and optionally to indicate RGB data. As another illustrative example, if the Data ID field of the CSI packet indicates the data includes raw video data, the processor selects the data type value at block **1112** to indicate video-type data and optionally to indicate raw data.

(135) In some embodiments, the data received at block **1104** may be received via one of multiple different communication links with the sensor (e.g., the links **124** and **148** of FIGS. **1-2**; the links **324** and **348** of FIGS. **3-4**; and the links **524** and **548** of FIGS. **5-6**), and the different communication links correspond to respective different types of data. Thus, in some embodiments in which the data received at block **1104** may be received via one of multiple different communication links with the sensor, the processor determines via which communication link the data was received, and selects the data type value at block **1112** based on the determined communication link via which the data was received.

(136) In some embodiments, the processor is preconfigured to select, at block **1112**, a particular data type value or to select from a particular subset of data type values that correspond to a sensor to which the processor is communicatively coupled (when the processor is not communicatively coupled to any other types of sensors). For example, if the processor is communicatively coupled to a microphone (and not to any other types of sensors), the processor is preconfigured to select, at block **1112**, a data type value corresponding to audio data, or to select from a particular subset of data type values that are relevant to microphones.

(137) In some embodiments, selecting the data type value at block **1112** comprises selecting the data type value from a set of multiple data type values that includes at least i) a first data type value corresponding to video data from a camera, and ii) a second data type value corresponding to non-video data. In some embodiments, selecting the data type value at block **1112** comprises selecting the data type value from a set of multiple data type values that includes at least i) a first data type value corresponding to video data from a camera, and one of, or any suitable combination of two or more of: ii) a second data type value corresponding to Lidar data from a Lidar device, iii) a third

data type value corresponding to Radar data from a Radar device, iv) a fourth data type value corresponding to audio data from a microphone, v) a fifth data type value corresponding to diagnostics data corresponding to the sensor, vi) a sixth data type value corresponding to OAM data corresponding to the sensor, vii) a seventh data type value corresponding to GPIO data corresponding to the sensor, viii) an eighth data type value corresponding to values of internal registers of the sensor, ix) a ninth data type value corresponding to data in a user-defined format, etc.

(138) Generating the intermediate frame at block **1108** also includes the processor generating, at block **1116**, the intermediate frame header to include one or more fields set to the data type value selected at block **1112** to indicate a type of data included in the intermediate frame payload.

(139) Generating the intermediate frame at block **1108** also includes the processor generating, at block **1118**, the intermediate frame payload to include at least some of the data received at block **1104**.

(140) At block **1120**, the intermediate frame generated at block **1108** is provided to an Ethernet network interface. In an embodiment, the processor provides the intermediate frame to the Ethernet network interface. In an embodiment, the formatter **144** provides the intermediate frame to the Ethernet MAC processor **152**.

(141) At block **1124**, the Ethernet network interface encapsulates the intermediate frame in an Ethernet packet. In an embodiment, the Ethernet MAC processor **152** encapsulates the intermediate frame in an Ethernet packet frame; and the Ethernet MAC processor **152** provides the Ethernet frame to the Ethernet PHY processor **156**, which generates an Ethernet packet.

(142) At block **1128**, the Ethernet network interface transmits the Ethernet packet via an Ethernet communication link. In an embodiment, the Ethernet PHY processor **156** transmits the Ethernet packet via an Ethernet link such as the Ethernet link **112**.

(143) In some embodiments, the method **1100** further includes generating the intermediate frame header to include routing information. In some embodiments, generating the intermediate frame header to include routing information comprises generating the intermediate frame header to include a source identifier and a destination identifier. In some embodiments, the method **1100** further comprises: determining, at the processor, the source identifier using information included within the data corresponding to the sensor; and determining, at the processor, the destination identifier using information included within the data corresponding to the sensor.

(144) In some embodiments, generating the header to include routing information comprises generating the header to include one or both of i) priority information, and ii) VLAN information. In some embodiments, the method **1100** further comprises: generating, by the Ethernet network interface, an IEEE 802.1Q tag for the Ethernet packet using the one or both of i) priority information, and ii) VLAN information in the header of the frame.

(145) In some embodiments and/or implementations, the data received at block **1104** includes flow identifier information that indicates a data flow, among multiple data flows, to which the data received at block **1104** belongs, and the processor uses the flow identifier information in the data received at block **1104** to select some of the routing information. For example, CSI packets include a virtual channel field that includes flow identification information that indicates a data flow, among multiple data flows, to which data within the CSI packet belongs. In some embodiments and/or implementations in which receiving data at block **1104** includes receiving a CSI packet, the processor uses the flow identifier information in the virtual channel field of the CSI packet to select routing information to be included in the intermediate frame header. In some embodiments and/or implementations in which receiving data at block **1104** includes receiving a CSI packet, the processor uses the flow identifier information in the virtual channel field of the CSI packet to select a VLAN information to be included in the intermediate frame header.

(146) FIG. **12** is a flow diagram of another example method **1200** for communicating in a motor vehicle communication network, according to another embodiment. The method **1200** is

implemented by a network interface such as the network interface **160/208/360/560** of FIGS. **1-6**, according to various embodiments. The method **1200** is implemented in another suitable network interface in other embodiments.

(147) At block **1204**, an Ethernet network interface receives an Ethernet packet via an Ethernet communication link. In an embodiment, the Ethernet PHY processor **168** receives the Ethernet packet via an Ethernet link such as the Ethernet link **112**.

(148) At block **1208**, the Ethernet network interface decapsulates an intermediate frame from the Ethernet packet. For example, the Ethernet MAC processor **172** decapsulates the intermediate frame from an Ethernet packet, according to an embodiment. In an embodiment, the intermediate frame includes an intermediate frame header and an intermediate frame payload, the intermediate frame header having one or more fields that are set to a data type value that indicates a type of data included in the intermediate frame payload.

(149) At block **1212**, a processor receives the intermediate frame from the Ethernet network interface. For example, the de-formatter **180/122** receives the intermediate frame from the Ethernet MAC processor **172**.

(150) In an embodiment, the intermediate frame received at block **1212** includes data from a sensor in a motor vehicle. In at least some instances, the data received at block **1212** is sensing data output by the sensor (e.g., video data output by a camera; audio data output by a microphone; Lidar data output by a Lidar device; Radar data output by a Radar device; etc.). In other instances, the data received at block **1212** comprises diagnostics data, OAM data, GPIO data, values of registers of the sensor (e.g., status registers, configuration registers, etc.), data in a user-defined format different than a format used for the sensing data, etc.

(151) At block **1216**, the processor uses the data type value in the one or more fields of the intermediate frame header to determine the type of data included in the intermediate frame payload. In an embodiment, determining the type of data at block **1216** includes selecting the type of data from a set of multiple data types corresponding to different respective possible values of the one or more fields of the intermediate frame header, the set of multiple data types including at least i) video-type data from a camera that corresponds to a first possible data type value of the one or more fields of the intermediate frame header, and ii) non-video-type data that corresponds to a second possible data type value of the one or more fields of the intermediate frame header. In an embodiment, the de-formatter **180/122** uses the data type value in the one or more fields of the intermediate frame header to determine the type of data included in the intermediate frame payload.

(152) At block **1220**, the processor reformats data in the intermediate frame payload according to the type of data (determined at block **1216**) included in the payload into a format that at least one of: i) corresponds to a non-Ethernet PHY protocol, and ii) is recognized by an additional processor configured to process data from a sensor in a motor vehicle. For example, the de-formatter **180/122** reformats data in the intermediate frame payload into a format that at least one of: i) corresponds to a non-Ethernet PHY protocol associated with the communication link **192/392/592**, and ii) is recognized by the processor **108/204**.

(153) In some embodiments and/or implementations, the data format that i) corresponds to a non-Ethernet PHY protocol, and/or ii) is recognized by an additional processor corresponds to a packet format that includes one or more packet fields that can be set to indicate a data type of data included in the packet; and reformatting the data at block **1220** includes setting the one or more packet fields to a data type value corresponding to the type of data determined at block **1216**. For example, CSI packets include a Data ID field that includes data type information that indicates a data type included in the CSI packet. In some embodiments and/or implementations in which block **1220** includes reformatting data into a CSI packet, the processor uses the data type determined at block **1216** to set the Data ID field of the CSI packet.

(154) As an illustrative example, if the processor determines at block **1216** that the data type corresponds to a frame start, the processor sets the Data ID field of the CSI packet to indicate the

CSI packet includes a frame start and generates the CSI packet to include a frame start. As another illustrative example, if the processor determines at block **1216** that the data type corresponds to a frame end, the processor sets the Data ID field of the CSI packet to indicate the CSI packet includes a frame end and generates the CSI packet to include a frame end. As another illustrative example, if the processor determines at block **1216** that the data type corresponds to a line start, the processor sets the Data ID field of the CSI packet to indicate the CSI packet includes a line start and generates the CSI packet to include a line start. As another illustrative example, if the processor determines at block **1216** that the data type corresponds to a line end, the processor sets the Data ID field of the CSI packet to indicate the CSI packet includes a line end and generates the CSI packet to include a line end. As another illustrative example, if the processor determines at block **1216** that the data type corresponds to blanking interval information, the processor sets the Data ID field of the CSI packet to indicate the CSI packet includes blanking interval information and generates the CSI packet to include blanking interval information. As another illustrative example, if the processor determines at block **1216** that the data type corresponds to YUV data, the processor sets the Data ID field of the CSI packet to indicate the CSI packet includes YUV data and generates the CSI packet to include the YUV data. As another illustrative example, if the processor determines at block **1216** that the data type corresponds to RGB data, the processor sets the Data ID field of the CSI packet to indicate the CSI packet includes RGB data and generates the CSI packet to include the RGB data. As another illustrative example, if the processor determines at block **1216** that the data type corresponds to raw video data, the processor sets the Data ID field of the CSI packet to indicate the CSI packet includes raw video data and generates the CSI packet to include the raw video data.

(155) In some embodiments and/or implementations, the data format that i) corresponds to a non-Ethernet PHY protocol, and/or ii) is recognized by an additional processor corresponds to a packet format that includes one or more packet fields that can be set to indicate a flow, among multiple flows, to which the packet belongs; and reformatting the data at block **1220** includes setting the one or more packet fields to a particular flow. For example, in some embodiments and/or implementations, the intermediate frame header includes flow identifier information that indicates a data flow, among multiple data flows, to which the data in the intermediate frame belongs, and the processor uses the flow identifier information in the intermediate frame header to set the one or more packet fields that indicate the flow. For example, CSI packets include a virtual channel field that includes flow identification information that indicates a data flow, among multiple data flows, to which data within the CSI packet belongs. In some embodiments and/or implementations reformatting the data at block **1220** include generating a CSI packet, the processor uses the flow identifier information in the intermediate frame header to set the virtual channel field of the CSI packet.

(156) In some embodiments in which the processor reformats the data at block **1220** into a format that is recognized by the additional processor, the method **1200** optionally also includes: transmitting the data reformatted at block **1220** to the additional processor via a communication link. For example, the non-Ethernet PHY processor **188** transmits data to the processor **108** via the communication link **192/196/392/396/592/596**, according to an embodiment.

(157) In some embodiments, the data may be transmitted via one of multiple different communication links with the processor (e.g., the links **192** and **196** of FIG. **1**; the links **392** and **396** of FIG. **3**; and the links **592** and **596** of FIGS. **5**), and the different communication links correspond to respective different types of data. Thus, in some embodiments in which the data may be transmitted via one of multiple different communication links, the processor determines via which communication link the data is to be transmitted based on the data type determined at block **1216**.

(158) At least some of the various blocks, operations, and techniques described above may be implemented utilizing hardware, a processor executing firmware instructions, a processor executing

software instructions, or any combination thereof. When implemented utilizing a processor executing software or firmware instructions, the software or firmware instructions may be stored in any computer readable memory such as on a magnetic disk, an optical disk, or other storage medium, in a RAM or ROM or flash memory, processor, hard disk drive, optical disk drive, tape drive, etc. The software or firmware instructions may include machine readable instructions that, when executed by one or more processors, cause the one or more processors to perform various acts.

(159) When implemented in hardware, the hardware may comprise one or more of discrete components, an integrated circuit, an application-specific integrated circuit (ASIC), a programmable logic device (PLD), etc.

(160) While the present invention has been described with reference to specific examples, which are intended to be illustrative only and not to be limiting of the invention, changes, additions and/or deletions may be made to the disclosed embodiments without departing from the scope of the invention.

Claims

1. A method for communicating in a vehicular communication network, the method comprising: receiving, at a processor, a packet that includes data corresponding to a sensor, the packet being in a first format defined by a camera serial interface (CSI) protocol of the Mobile Industry Processor Interface (MIPI) Alliance; reformatting, at the processor, the packet in the first format defined by the CSI protocol to a second format that does not conform to any CSI protocol of the MIPI alliance, the reformatting including: i) selecting, based on a first field in the packet in the first format, a data type value from a set of multiple data type values corresponding to different respective types of data, ii) generating an intermediate frame that does not include the packet in the first format, the intermediate frame being generated to include a header in the second format and a payload in the second format, the payload including the data corresponding to the sensor, and iii) generating the header to include one or more second fields set to the data type value; providing, by the processor, the intermediate frame to an Ethernet network interface; encapsulating, at the Ethernet network interface, the intermediate frame in an Ethernet packet; and transmitting, by the Ethernet network interface, the Ethernet packet via an Ethernet link.

2. The method of claim 1, wherein reformatting the packet in the first format defined by the CSI protocol to the second format comprises: selecting, based on a data identifier (ID) field in the packet in the first format, the data type value from the set of multiple data type values corresponding to different respective types of data, the set of multiple data type values including at least i) a first data type value corresponding to video data from a camera, and ii) a second data type value corresponding to non-video data.

3. The method of claim 2, wherein: the processor is communicatively coupled to the sensor via multiple communication links; the method further comprises determining, at the processor, a communication link, among the multiple communication links, via which the data corresponding to the sensor was received; and selecting the data type value from the set of multiple data type values comprises: selecting the data type value further based on the determined communication link, among the multiple communication link, via which the data corresponding to the sensor was received.

4. The method of claim 2, wherein the intermediate frame is a first intermediate frame, the header of the first intermediate frame is a first header, the payload of the first intermediate frame is a first payload, and the Ethernet packet is a first Ethernet packet, and wherein the method further comprises: receiving, at the processor, one of i) general purpose input/output (GPIO) data corresponding to the sensor, ii) diagnostic data corresponding to the sensor, and iii) Operation and Management (OAM) data corresponding to the sensor; generating, at the processor, a second

intermediate frame to include a second header in the second format and a second payload in the second format, wherein generating the second intermediate frame includes: selecting a data type value for the second intermediate frame from the set of multiple data type values, including selecting the data type value to be a value corresponding to the one of i) GPIO data, ii) diagnostic data, and iii) OAM data, generating the second header of the second intermediate frame in the second format to include one or more third fields set to the selected data type value to indicate a type of data included in the second payload of the second intermediate frame, and generating the second payload of the second intermediate frame to include the one of i) the GPIO data corresponding to the sensor, ii) the diagnostic data corresponding to the sensor, and iii) the OAM data corresponding to the sensor; providing, by the processor, the second intermediate frame to the Ethernet network interface; encapsulating, at the Ethernet network interface, the second intermediate frame in a second Ethernet packet; and transmitting, by the Ethernet network interface, the second Ethernet packet via the Ethernet link.

5. The method of claim 2, wherein the intermediate frame is a first intermediate frame, the header of the first intermediate frame is a first header, the payload of the first intermediate frame is a first payload, and the Ethernet packet is a first Ethernet packet, and wherein the method further comprises: receiving, at the processor, data corresponding to the sensor in a user-defined format; generating, at the processor, a second intermediate frame to include a second header in the second format and a second payload in the second format, wherein generating the second intermediate frame includes: selecting a data type value for the second intermediate frame from the set of multiple data type values, including selecting the data type value to be a value indicating the second payload includes user-defined data, generating the second header of the second intermediate frame in the second format to include one or more third fields set to the selected data type value to indicate a type of data included in the second payload of the second intermediate frame, and generating the second payload of the second intermediate frame to include the data corresponding to the sensor in a user-defined format; providing, by the processor, the second intermediate frame to the Ethernet network interface; encapsulating, at the Ethernet network interface, the second intermediate frame in a second Ethernet packet; and transmitting, by the Ethernet network interface, the second Ethernet packet via the Ethernet link.

6. The method of claim 1, wherein the processor is a first processor, the header is a first header, the payload is a first payload, and the Ethernet network interface is a first Ethernet network interface, the method further comprising: receiving, at a second Ethernet network interface, the Ethernet packet, the Ethernet packet received via the Ethernet link; decapsulating, at the second Ethernet network interface, the intermediate frame from the Ethernet packet, the intermediate frame including the first header in the second format and the payload in the second format; providing, by the second Ethernet network interface, the intermediate frame to a second processor; and generating, at the second processor, the packet in the first format defined by the CSI protocol of the MIPI Alliance, including i) using header information in the first header of the intermediate frame to populate one or more header fields of a second header of the packet in the first format, and ii) using payload information in the intermediate frame to generate a second payload of the packet in the first format.

7. The method of claim 6, wherein: generating the packet in the CSI protocol format comprises using the data type value in the one or more fields of the first header to set a data identifier (ID) field in the second header of the packet in the first format.

8. The method of claim 7, wherein: the first header of the intermediate frame includes i) a general data type field set to a general data type value from a set of multiple general data type values corresponding to different respective groups of types of data, and ii) a data sub-type field to a data sub-type value from a set of multiple data sub-type values, wherein the general data type value and the data sub-type value together indicates the type of data included in the first payload of the intermediate frame; and using the data type value to set the data ID field in the second header

comprises using the general data type value and the data sub-type value to set the data ID field in the second header.

9. The method of claim 8, wherein: the general data type field is set to a general video type value to indicate the first payload of the intermediate frame includes video-type data; the data sub-type field is set to a video data sub-type value to indicate a subtype of video data included in the first payload of the intermediate frame; and using the data type value to set the data ID field in the second header comprises using the general video data type value and the video data sub-type value to set the data ID field in the second header.

10. The method of claim 6, wherein the Ethernet packet is a first Ethernet packet, the intermediate frame is a first intermediate frame, and the packet in the first format is a first packet, wherein the method further comprises: receiving, at the second Ethernet network interface, a second Ethernet packet, the second Ethernet packet received via the Ethernet link; decapsulating, at the Ethernet network interface, a second intermediate frame from the second Ethernet packet, the second intermediate frame including a third header in the second format and a third payload in the second format, the third payload including data corresponding to the sensor, wherein the third header of the second intermediate frame includes one or more fields set to a data type value that indicates a type of data included in the third payload of the second intermediate frame, the data type value from a set of multiple data type values corresponding to different respective types of data, the set of multiple data type values including a value that indicates the third payload is in a user-defined format; providing, by the second Ethernet network interface, the second intermediate frame to the second processor; and generating, at the second processor, a second packet, including i) using header information in the third header of the second intermediate frame to populate one or more header fields of a fourth header of the second packet, and ii) using payload information in the second intermediate frame to generate a fourth payload of the second packet.

11. The method of claim 6, wherein the Ethernet packet is a first Ethernet packet, the intermediate frame is a first intermediate frame, and the packet in the first format is a first packet, wherein the method further comprises: receiving, at the second Ethernet network interface, a second Ethernet packet, the second Ethernet packet received via the Ethernet link; decapsulating, at the second Ethernet network interface, a second intermediate frame from the second Ethernet packet, the second intermediate frame including a third header in the second format and a third payload in the second format, the third payload including data corresponding to the sensor, wherein the third header of the second intermediate frame includes one or more fields set to a data type value that indicates a type of data included in the third payload of the second intermediate frame, the data type value from a set of multiple data type values corresponding to different respective types of data, the set of multiple data type values including one or more of i) a first value corresponding to general purpose input/output (GPIO) data, ii) a second value corresponding to diagnostic data, and iii) and a third value corresponding to Operation and Management (OAM) data; providing, by the second Ethernet network interface, the second intermediate frame to the second processor; and generating, at the second processor, a second packet, including i) using header information in the third header of the second intermediate frame to populate one or more header fields of a fourth header of the second packet, and ii) using payload information in the second intermediate frame to generate a fourth payload of the second packet.

12. A communication device, comprising: a processor configured to: receive a packet that includes data corresponding to a sensor, the packet being in a first format defined by a camera serial interface (CSI) protocol of the Mobile Industry Processor Interface (MIPI) Alliance, reformat the packet in the first format defined by the CSI protocol to a second format that does not conform to any CSI protocol of the MIPI alliance, the reformatting including: i) selecting, based on a first field in the packet in the first format, a data type value from a set of multiple data type values corresponding to different respective types of data, ii) generating an intermediate frame that does not include the packet in the first format, the intermediate frame being generated to include a

header in the second format and a payload in the second format, the payload including the data corresponding to the sensor, and iii) generating the header to include one or more second fields set to the data type value, and outputting the intermediate frame to an Ethernet network interface; and an Ethernet network interface configured to: receive the intermediate frame output by the processor, encapsulate the intermediate frame in an Ethernet packet, and transmit the Ethernet packet via an Ethernet link.

13. The communication device of claim 12, wherein the processor is configured to: select, based on a data identifier (ID) field in the packet in the first format, the data type value from the set of multiple data type values corresponding to different respective types of data, the set of multiple data type values including at least i) a first data type value corresponding to video data from a camera, and ii) a second data type value corresponding to non-video data.

14. The communication device of claim 13, wherein the processor is communicatively coupled to the sensor via multiple communication links, and wherein the processor is further configured to: determine a communication link, among the multiple communication links, via which the data corresponding to the sensor was received; and select the data type value further based on the determined communication link, among the multiple communication link, via which the data corresponding to the sensor was received.

15. The communication device of claim 13, wherein the intermediate frame is a first intermediate frame, the header of the first intermediate frame is a first header, the payload of the first intermediate frame is a first payload, and the Ethernet packet is a first Ethernet packet, and wherein: the processor is further configured to: receive one of i) general purpose input/output (GPIO) data corresponding to the sensor, ii) diagnostic data corresponding to the sensor, and iii) Operation and Management (OAM) data corresponding to the sensor, and generate a second intermediate frame to include a second header in the second format and a second payload in the second format, wherein generating the second intermediate frame includes: selecting a data type value for the second intermediate frame from the set of multiple data type values, including selecting the data type value to be a value corresponding to the one of i) GPIO data, ii) diagnostic data, and iii) OAM data, generating the second header of the second intermediate frame in the second format to include one or more third fields set to the selected data type value to indicate a type of data included in the second payload of the second intermediate frame, and generating the second payload of the second intermediate frame to include the one of i) the GPIO data corresponding to the sensor, ii) the diagnostic data corresponding to the sensor, and iii) the OAM data corresponding to the sensor; the processor is further configured to output the second intermediate frame; and the Ethernet network interface is further configured to: receive the second intermediate from the processor, encapsulate the second intermediate frame in a second Ethernet packet, and transmit the second Ethernet packet via the Ethernet link.

16. The communication device of claim 13, wherein the intermediate frame is a first intermediate frame, the header of the first intermediate frame is a first header, the payload of the first intermediate frame is a first payload, and the Ethernet packet is a first Ethernet packet, and wherein: the processor is further configured to: receive data corresponding to the sensor in a user-defined format, and generate a second intermediate frame to include a second header in the second format and a second payload in the second format, wherein generating the second intermediate frame includes: selecting a data type value for the second intermediate frame from the set of multiple data type values, including selecting the data type value to be a value indicating the second payload includes user-defined data, generating the second header of the second intermediate frame in the second format to include one or more third fields set to the selected data type value to indicate a type of data included in the second payload of the second intermediate frame, and generating the second payload of the second intermediate frame to include the data corresponding to the sensor in a user-defined format; the processor is further configured to output the second intermediate frame; and the Ethernet network interface is further configured to: receive the second

intermediate from the processor, encapsulate the second intermediate frame in a second Ethernet packet, and transmit the second Ethernet packet via the Ethernet link.

17. A system comprising the communication device of claim 12, wherein the communication device is a first communication device, the processor is a first processor, the header is a first header, the payload is a first payload, and the Ethernet network interface is a first Ethernet network interface, wherein the system further comprises a second communication device coupled to the first communication device via the Ethernet link, the second communication device comprising: a second Ethernet network interface configured to: receive the Ethernet packet via the Ethernet link; decapsulate the intermediate frame from the Ethernet packet, the intermediate frame including the first header in the second format and the first payload in the second format, and output the intermediate frame; and a second processor coupled to the second Ethernet network interface, the second processor configured to: receive the intermediate frame output by the second Ethernet network interface, and generate the packet in the first format, including i) using header information in the first header of the intermediate frame to populate one or more header fields of a second header of the packet in the first format, and ii) using payload information in the intermediate frame to generate a second payload of the packet in the first format.

18. The system of claim 17, wherein: the second processor is further configured to use the data type value in the one or more fields of the first header to set a data identifier (ID) field in the second header of the packet in the first format.

19. The system of claim 18, wherein: the first header of the intermediate frame includes i) a general data type field set to a general data type value from a set of multiple general data type values corresponding to different respective groups of types of data, and ii) a data sub-type field to a data sub-type value from a set of multiple data sub-type values, wherein the general data type value and the data sub-type value together indicates the type of data included in the first payload of the intermediate frame; and the second processor is configured to use the general data type value and the data sub-type value to set the data ID field in the second header.

20. The system of claim 19, wherein: the general data type field is set to a general video type value to indicate the first payload of the intermediate frame includes video-type data; the data sub-type field is set to a video data sub-type value to indicate a subtype of video data included in the first payload of the intermediate frame; and the second processor is configured to use the general video data type value and the video data sub-type value to set the data ID field in the second header.

21. The system of claim 17, wherein the Ethernet packet is a first Ethernet packet, the intermediate frame is a first intermediate frame, and the packet in the first format is a first packet, and wherein: the second Ethernet network interface configured to: receive a second Ethernet packet via the Ethernet link, decapsulate a second intermediate frame from the second Ethernet packet, the second intermediate frame including a third header in the second format and a third payload in the second format, the third payload including data corresponding to the sensor, wherein the third header of the second intermediate frame includes one or more fields set to a data type value that indicates a type of data included in the third payload of the second intermediate frame, the data type value from a set of multiple data type values corresponding to different respective types of data, the set of multiple data type values including one or more of i) a first value corresponding to general purpose input/output (GPIO) data, ii) a second value corresponding to diagnostic data, and iii) and a third value corresponding to Operation and Management (OAM) data, and output the second intermediate frame; and the second processor is further configured to: receive the second intermediate frame output by the second Ethernet network interface, and generate a second packet, including i) using header information in the third header of the second intermediate frame to populate one or more header fields of a fourth header of the second packet, and ii) using payload information in the second intermediate frame to generate a fourth payload of the second packet.

22. The system of claim 17, wherein the Ethernet packet is a first Ethernet packet, the intermediate frame is a first intermediate frame, and the packet in the first format is a first packet, and wherein:

the second Ethernet network interface configured to: receive a second Ethernet packet via the Ethernet link; decapsulate a second intermediate frame from the second Ethernet packet, the second intermediate frame including a third header in the second format and a third payload in the second format, the third payload including data corresponding to the sensor, wherein the third header of the second intermediate frame includes one or more fields set to a data type value that indicates a type of data included in the third payload of the second intermediate frame, the data type value from a set of multiple data type values corresponding to different respective types of data, the set of multiple data type values including a value that indicates the third payload is in a user-defined format, and output the second intermediate frame; and the second processor is further configured to: receive the second intermediate frame output by the second Ethernet network interface, and generate a second packet, including i) using header information in the third header of the second intermediate frame to populate one or more header fields of a fourth header of the second packet, and ii) using payload information in the second intermediate frame to generate a fourth payload of the second packet.
